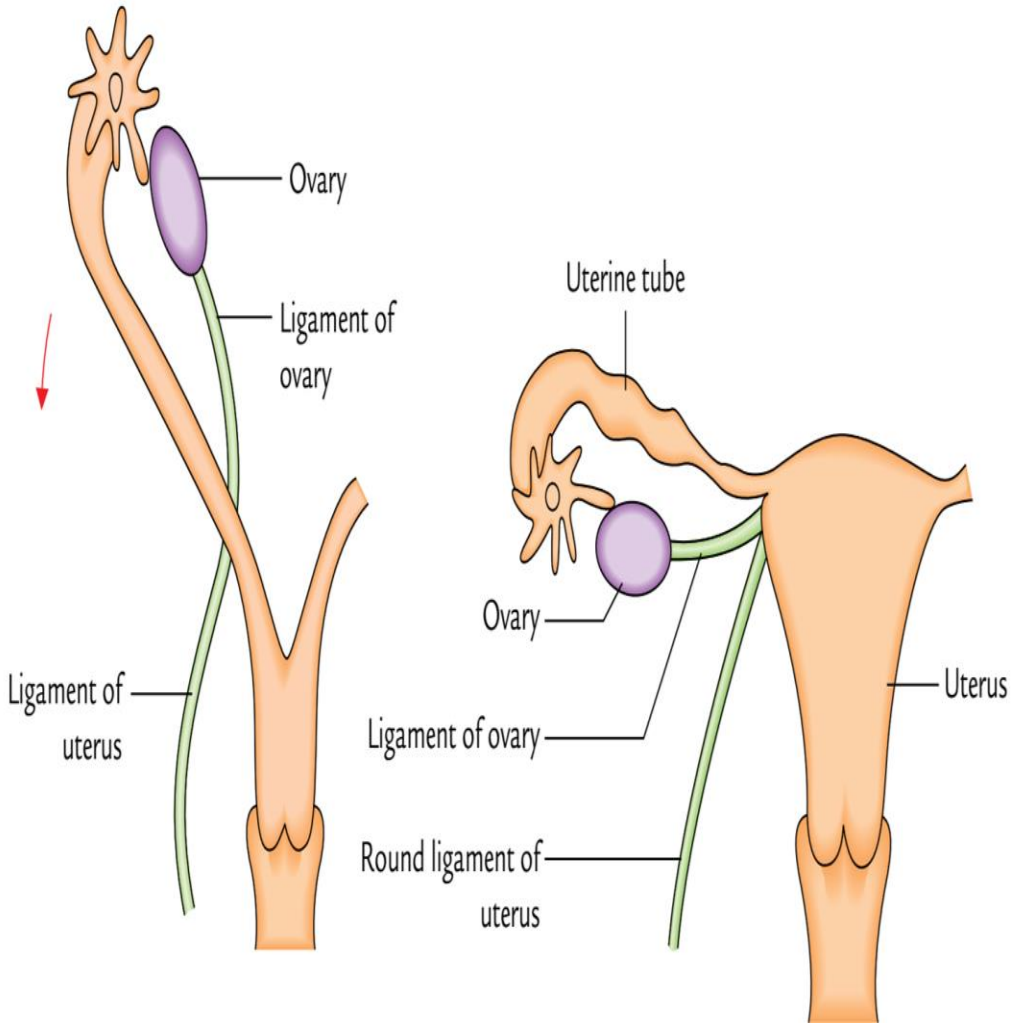
Descent of the ovaries

- The ovary develops in the abdominal cavity.
- The ovary descends to the pelvic cavity by contraction of the **gubernaculum ovarii.**
- The gubernaculum is attached to the ovary at one end and to the labia majora at the other end. It passes through the inguinal canal.

- The gubernaculum is divided into 2 parts :

a. A part extends from the ovary to the uterus forms ovarian ligament.

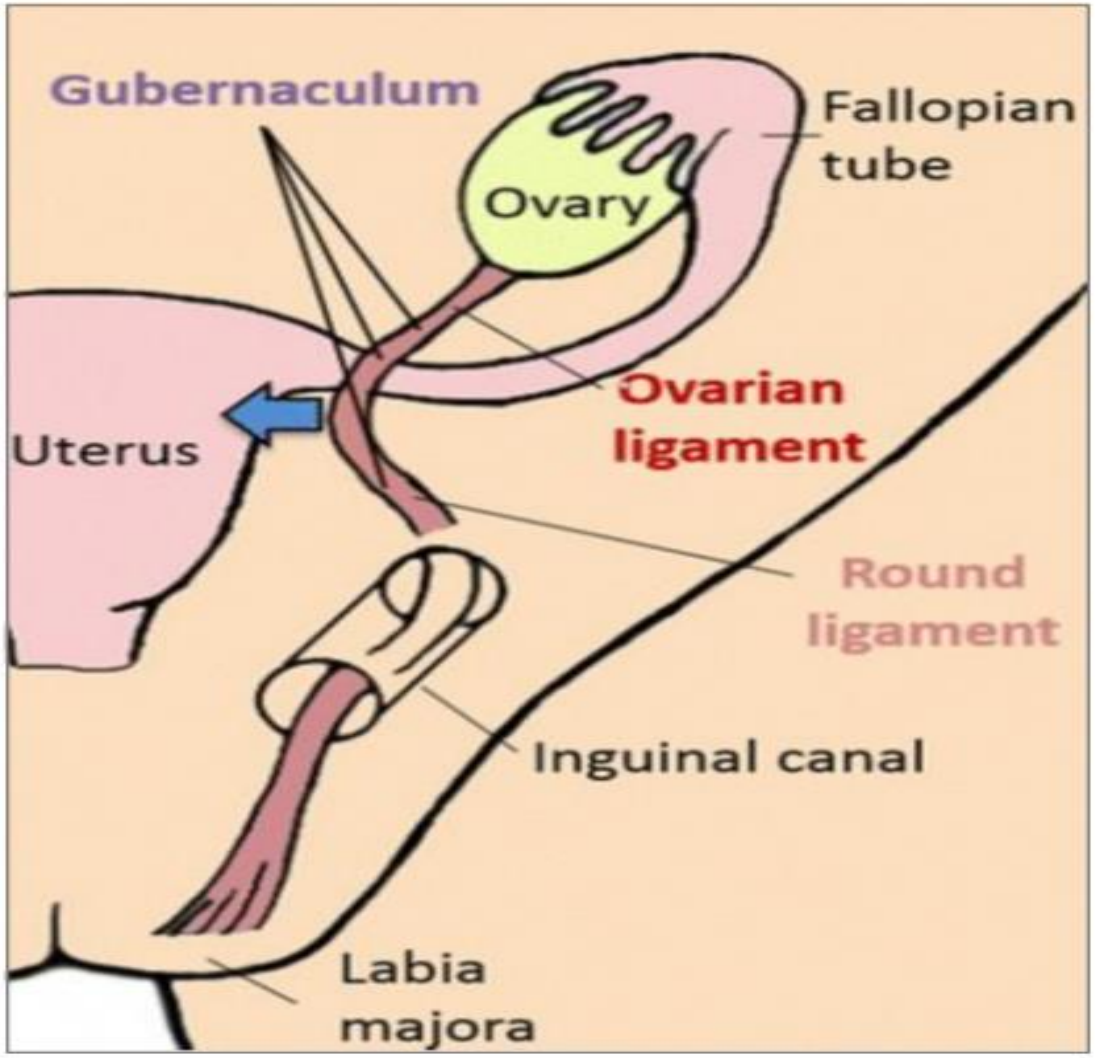
b. The other part extends from the uterus to the labia majora and is called round ligament of the uterus.



Congenital abnormalities

- Ectopic ovary:

- The ovary may be found in the inguinal canal or in the labia majora.



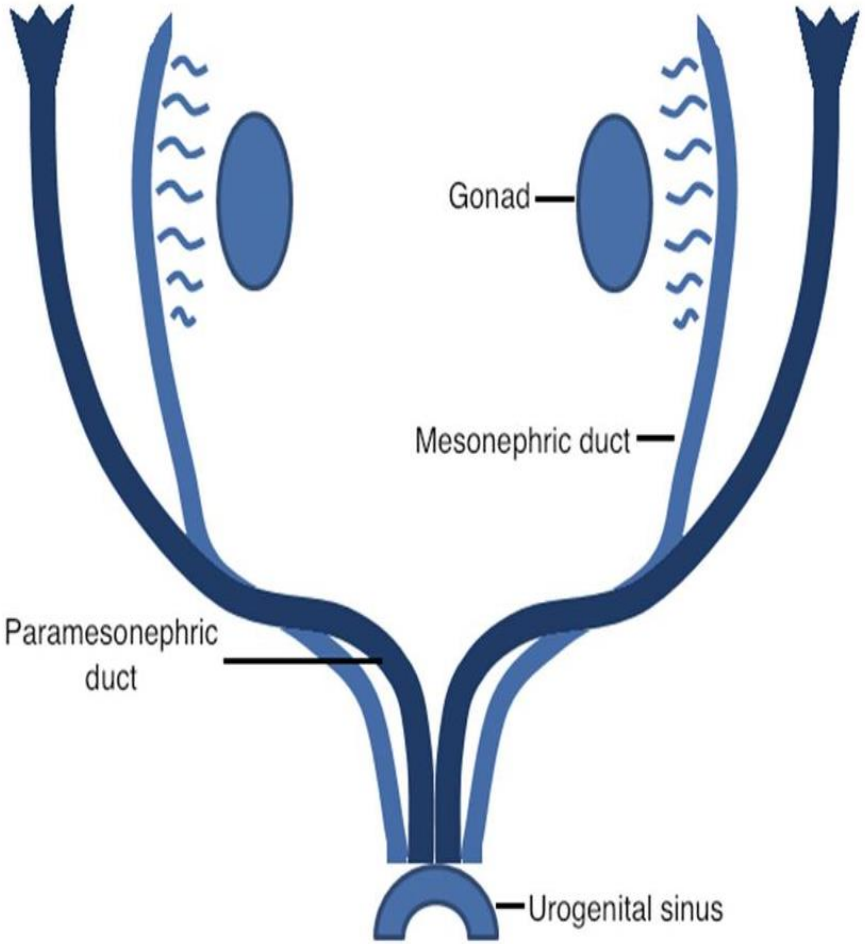
Development of the genital ducts

- Initially, both male and female embryos have two pairs of genital ducts: ***mesonephric*** (**Wolffian**) ducts and ***paramesonephric*** (**Müllerian**) ducts.

- The testis secretes:

1- Testosterone that stimulates the development of mesonephric ducts.

2- Antimullerian hormone that suppresses the paramesonephric ducts



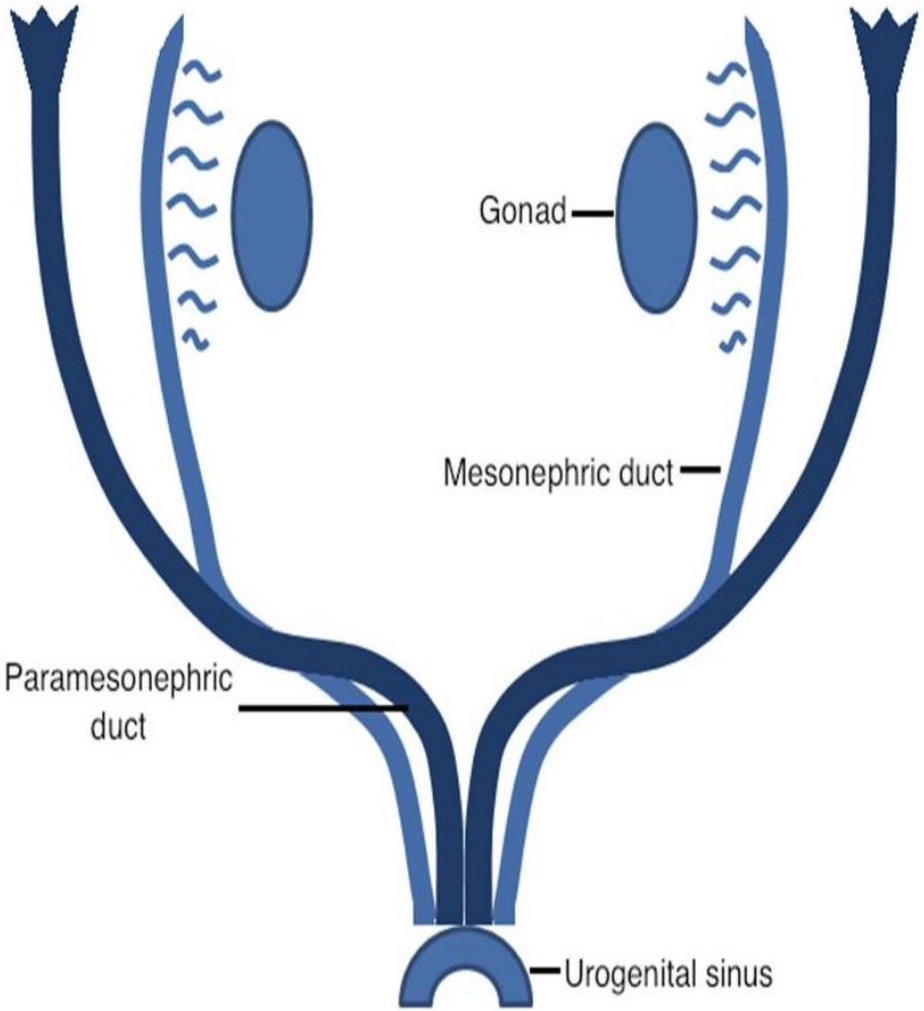
Development of the genital ducts

- Mesonephric duct & tubules:

The kidney develops in 3 sets; pronephros, mesonephros and metanephros (permanent kidney).

- The mesonephros has mesonephric tubules that open in the mesonephric ducts.

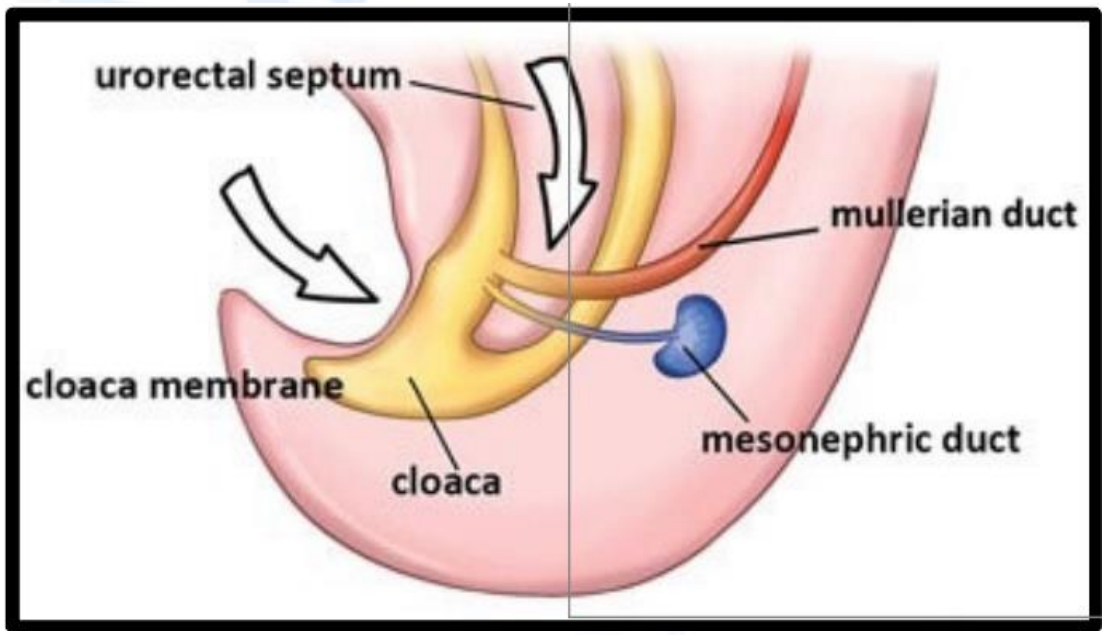
- The mesonephric ducts open into the urogenital sinus.

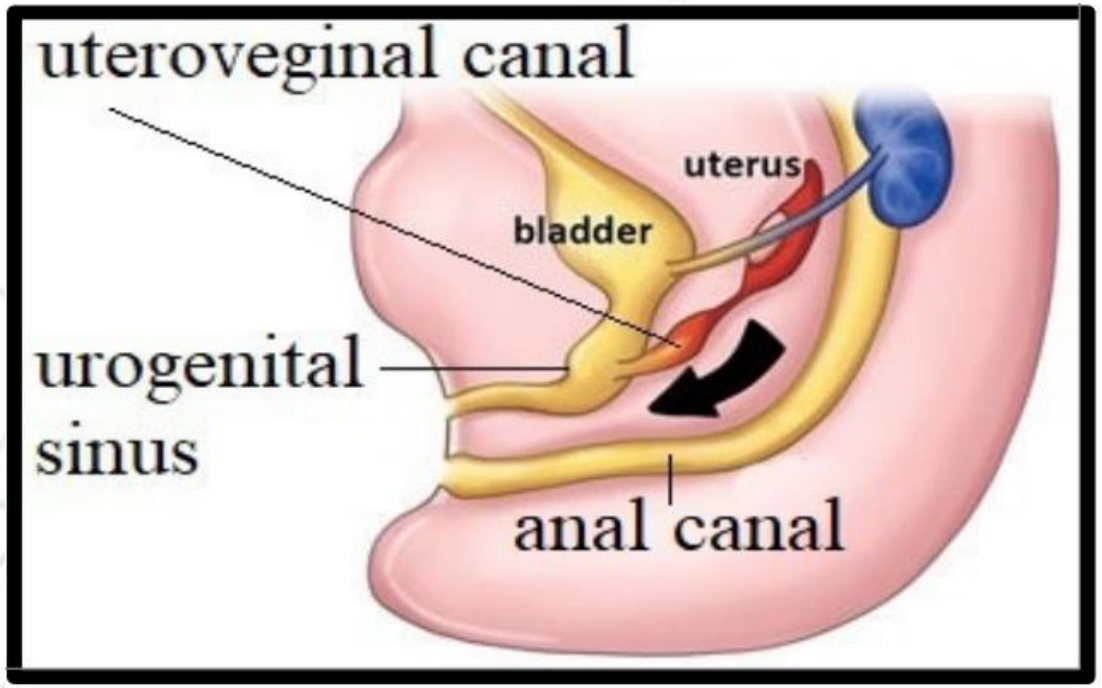


- Urogenital sinus :

- The distal part of the hindgut (endoderm) is called cloaca.

- The urorectal septum divides the cloaca into the urogenital sinus anteriorly and the anal canal posteriorly.





Paramesonephric duct :

- It arises as a longitudinal invagination of the epithelium lateral to the mesonephric duct.

- Its upper end opens into the abdominal cavity.
- It first runs lateral to the mesonephric duct, crosses it anteriorly to its medial side and then grows downwards.

